

Chapter 57 - Keeping the Appointment

Feng Yue hung up the phone, and only then did Mother Feng push her upstairs to change clothes.

Feng Yue wore a high-waisted houndstooth wool coat on top, with a matching pattern half-skirt below, and a pair of lace-up long boots that wrapped around her calves up to her knees. The whole ensemble made her look tall and elegant.

Mother Feng looked at her with satisfaction. "Very good, very good. Our little one is getting more and more beautiful."

Feng Yue couldn't help but laugh, shaking her head somewhat helplessly. "So I'm going out now?"

Mother Feng waved her hand. "Go ahead, go ahead. You can stay out all night if you want."

Feng Yue ignored her mother, picked up her car keys, and went out.

Sen'er Hotel was one of Beijing's most popular hotels recently. Unlike Beijing's conventional five-star hotels, rather than focusing on guest accommodation comfort, it emphasized developing entertainment facilities within the hotel.

It was precisely these entertainment facilities that gradually gave this hotel some status among Beijing's rich second generation.

On important days like today - New Year's Eve - Sen'er Hotel's reservations had long been fully booked.

That Qian He and her group of girls could book a spot at Sen'er Hotel for a small gathering was largely thanks to Qian He's background.

Feng Yue parked her car at the hotel entrance. She got out and handed her keys to the valet at the door, then called Qian He.

"Miss Qian, I'm at the entrance."

"Great! I'll be right down."

Feng Yue hung up and waited in the lobby for a while before Qian He came down in the elevator.

Feng Yue originally couldn't quite place Qian He's face, but seeing the sweet and adorable dimples at the corners of her mouth, she finally felt the other person looked familiar.

"Miss Qian, long time no see. Thank you so much for inviting me." Feng Yue was carrying a bag of small snacks, all made by herself when she had nothing to do at home. "These are all things I made myself. Let's take them up for everyone to try."

"That's wonderful! We've all watched your videos and have wanted to try your cooking for so long!" Qian He smiled happily, her eyes crinkling and the dimples at her lips appearing. "Oh, and just call me by my name - no need to be so formal."

Qian He probably had a natural, extraordinary affinity that allowed her to communicate well with anyone.

Feng Yue felt very comfortable interacting with her, so she readily nodded and agreed.

"Then let's go up. Everyone's upstairs singing karaoke right now."

Feng Yue was the type who was completely tone-deaf. Her first reaction upon hearing about KTV was resistance, though she didn't show it too obviously. She asked tentatively, "There's KTV upstairs?"

Qian He nodded. "Mm-hmm, this hotel has a huge entertainment area. You can do whatever you want to play. If there's anything special you want to do, we can go together later."

Feng Yue nodded awkwardly, just praying they wouldn't make her sing later.

The two took the elevator to the seventeenth floor. From the seventeenth floor all the way to the top floor - the thirty-seventh floor - was entirely the hotel's entertainment area.

The KTV private room was much more spacious than regular KTV rooms, and there were no unpleasant cigarette smoke or other odors inside.

The arrival of Qian He and Feng Yue drew everyone's attention to them.

Qian He turned on the brightest light in the room, and the girl who was singing also pressed pause.

Everyone was meeting this "legendary figure" Feng Yue for the first time, so their curiosity about her was greatest.

Qian He was probably worried everyone would feel awkward, so she spoke up to introduce everyone. "This is Feng Yue. You should all know her, right?"

Then she introduced Feng Yue to the others, pointing to the girl sitting on the round platform holding the microphone. "This is Zhiyu¹. Just call her Xiao Yu."

Feng Yue nodded to her.

Qian He then pointed to the girl sitting on the sofa playing games on her phone, occasionally muttering things. "This is Xu Yan. She's a gaming streamer on Cat Station Video Live, but because her skills aren't very good, she hasn't had much success."

Xu Yan, sitting on the sofa, probably heard Qian He's words and shot her a cold look.

Qian He shrugged, completely ignoring her.

This was Feng Yue's first time meeting someone with a similar profession to hers offline, so she was somewhat curious about Xu Yan.

"Hey, I'm not popular because my skills are bad - don't listen to Hua'er's nonsense." Xu Yan finished a game and put away her phone.

Hua'er was Xu Yan's nickname for Qian He. The two seemed to be very close friends.

There were five or six other girls in the room. Qian He introduced them all to Feng Yue one by one, until finally introducing the one sitting in the corner.

"Oh right, Xiao Li came today too. You two should know each other, right!" Qian He said, bringing Feng Yue over to Wang Huili's side.

Feng Yue hadn't expected Wang Huili to be here. She looked quietly at Wang Huili.

She hadn't forgotten how this person had splashed champagne all over her in public before.

"Speaking of which, it was actually Xiao Li who suggested we invite you today. Otherwise, we wouldn't have dared to call you."

Wang Huili smiled sweetly, ignoring Feng Yue's obvious hostility. "I did some wrong things to Miss Feng before. I hope Miss Feng won't hold it against me."

Feng Yue said nothing, just stared at her steadily. Wang Huili's coercive way of demanding forgiveness made Feng Yue very uncomfortable.

The three of them sat in the corner while the others didn't notice what they were talking about.

Qian He didn't understand the grudge between the two, so she didn't know what to say now.

"I hope Miss Feng can be magnanimous and forgive my previous ignorance. I hope we can let bygones be bygones with a smile." As she spoke, Wang Huili picked up a glass of wine and raised it toward Feng Yue.

Just as she was about to drink it all down, Qian He reached out and grabbed her wrist.

Feng Yue's raised hand quietly returned to its original position.

"Xiao He?" Wang Huili looked at Qian He in confusion.

Qian He looked up with her small face, her expression serious and solemn. "Xiao Li, I don't think you should say things like that. If you want to apologize, then apologize properly. Why are you apologizing to Miss Feng in a way that's like moral blackmail?"

Wang Huili was left speechless, holding the wine glass in one hand, standing there unable to drink or not drink.

She cursed Qian He ten thousand times in her heart - this naive girl!

Feng Yue was somewhat surprised by what Qian He said. She hadn't expected Qian He to so blatantly bring Wang Huili's intentions out into the open.

Feng Yue curved her lips, reached out and took the wine glass from Wang Huili's hand. "Miss Wang, what happened between us isn't a big deal. Anyway, you already paid the price for what you did in the restaurant at that time. If I were still holding grudges, it would be somewhat unreasonable of me."

"So we don't need to drink this wine. I don't accept just anyone's apology."

With that, Feng Yue poured the wine from the glass onto the carpet on the floor in front of both of them.

Wang Huili felt her face burning hot, as if she had been slapped in public.

"Miss Feng, let's go sit over there. We'll be moving to another location in a little while." Seeing the situation between the two wasn't good, Qian He proactively took Feng Yue to sit as far away from Wang Huili as possible.

Wang Huili watched the two walk away with an expressionless face, then immediately took out her phone from her bag and sent a text message to someone in her contacts.

【The person is here. Act according to plan.】

Feng Yue sat down on the sofa with Qian He beside her, and Xu Yan, who was playing games, next to that.

Zhiyu on the platform finished singing a song and insisted on pulling Feng Yue up to sing. The other girls were also egging her on.

Feng Yue couldn't escape and was dragged onto the platform by Zhiyu, this natural microphone hog, and the other girls.

Xu Yan glanced at Feng Yue, who was caught up in the enthusiasm, then lowered her head to continue playing. "I told you long ago to have less contact with that Wang family girl, but you wouldn't listen."

Qian He glared at Xu Yan resentfully. "How was I supposed to know she would use me?"

"Do you think Feng Yue hates me now?" Qian He said, pouting dejectedly.

Xu Yan gave her a blank look then looked away again. "I really don't understand how you can treat Feng Yue like an idol to chase after."

"Hmph! Don't interfere with this beautiful girl's business!" Qian He proudly raised her chin.

"Besides, what's wrong with Feng Yue? She's beautiful and great at cooking, and she's a really good person too. Why can't I like someone who's both attractive and capable?"

"Fine, fine, fine. I give up on you. You can like whoever you want - I have no objections." Xu Yan moved her fingers and perfectly scored a double kill.

"Sigh, why did Xiao Li have to be like that? If Feng Yue ends up hating me because of her, I'll be so upset." Qian He flopped onto Xu Yan like a boneless creature.

Xu Yan seemed used to her movements. "I don't think Feng Yue is that type of person. Besides, didn't you just help stop Wang Huili? It should be fine - she won't hate you over such a small thing."

"Sigh, I hope so."

On Feng Yue's side, she had been pulled onto the platform by Zhiyu, and the next song happened to be "Liang Liang²."

Looking at the song title displayed on the screen, Feng Yue felt that the first one to "cool down" might be herself.

Zhiyu, Qian He, and Xu Yan were very good friends, so naturally she knew about Qian He's little fangirl mentality toward Feng Yue.

She was determined to get some fan benefits for her good friend, so for the first time ever, this microphone hog gave one of the mics to Feng Yue.

"Miss Feng, since this is our first meeting, let's make friends through song! After we sing this song, we'll definitely be good friends!"

Feng Yue: ...?

Who makes friends by singing "Liang Liang"?!

"Zhiyu, I really can't sing well. Can we try something else? We don't have to sing!"

"It's okay! I'll lead you in singing - I know this song well!"

After some extreme back-and-forth, Zhiyu ultimately won, and Feng Yue was forced to pick up the microphone.

Seeing Feng Yue pick up the mic, everyone focused their attention on her. Qian He, the little fangirl, was already watching Feng Yue with starry eyes.

"Liang Liang" was a duet between a man and woman. To help Feng Yue relax and not be so nervous, Zhiyu started by singing the female part.

Zhiyu's vocal range, pitch, tone, and articulation were all perfect.

Everyone looked at Feng Yue with great anticipation.

Feng Yue steeled herself and began to sing.

As soon as she opened her mouth, Feng Yue missed the beat, and then her tone-deaf voice came through the microphone.

Zhiyu's face stiffened as she looked toward the person sitting...

She quickly tried to lead Feng Yue back on track, but Feng Yue's tone-deafness was too profound - she couldn't lead her at all.

Seeing everyone's expressions, Feng Yue knew she really wasn't singing well, so she looked somewhat embarrassed and wanted to stop.

But at this moment, someone sitting in the corner showed a trace of mockery and derision.

Footnotes:

¹ Zhiyu (芷瑜) - A Chinese given name meaning "fragrant jade"

² "Liang Liang" (凉凉) - A popular Chinese duet song meaning "Cold/Cool." The song is known for being emotionally moving but technically challenging to sing well.